



Bucks 11 Plus Tests
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FREE PRACTICE PAPER · 2026 EDITION

Bucks 11+ Free Practice Paper

12 GL-style questions covering the four subject areas of the Bucks 11+, with full worked explanations.

● **VERBAL REASONING**
3 questions

● **MATHEMATICS**
3 questions

● **NON-VERBAL REASONING**
3 questions

● **ENGLISH COMPREHENSION**
3 questions

Suggested time: 20 minutes · Rough paper recommended
Suitable for Year 4–Year 5 children preparing for the Bucks 11+

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How to use this paper

Tips for getting the most from this practice session

1 Find a quiet space

Sit with your child if it helps them feel settled, but let them work through the questions independently. A first attempt without prompting gives you the clearest picture of which areas to focus on next.

2 Aim for 20 minutes

GL-style papers are timed. 20 minutes for 12 questions is approximately 100 seconds per question — a useful pace to practise. Use a timer, but don't stress if your child needs a little longer in early attempts.

3 Mark together — read the explanations

The worked explanations are more valuable than the score itself. Reading them together helps your child understand the *approach*, not just the answer.

4 Look at the pattern across subjects

Notice which subject areas felt easier or harder. Balanced practice across all four areas — Verbal Reasoning, Maths, Non-Verbal Reasoning, and Comprehension — is generally the most effective preparation strategy.

LOOKING FOR A MORE DETAILED PICTURE?

Our free 12-question Readiness Check is timed, marked instantly, and returns an indicative readiness score against our 121 readiness benchmark — plus your child's three areas for improvement.



Independent practice indicator — not an official test score.

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Questions

12 questions · Suggested 20 minutes · Circle or write your answers on rough paper

Q1 · VERBAL REASONING · ANTONYMS

Which word means the opposite of 'peace'?

A war

B violence

C conflict

D chaos

Q2 · VERBAL REASONING · LETTER SEQUENCE

What comes next in the sequence? A E D H G ?

A K

B Q

C G

D M

Q3 · VERBAL REASONING · CODES

In a code, LAKE is coded as 3175 and KALE is coded as 7135. What is the code for LEAK?

A 3517

B 3571

C 3751

D 3157

Q4 · MATHEMATICS · PERCENTAGES

A jacket costs £95. It is reduced by 40% in a sale. What is the sale price?

A £57

B £38

C £55

D £133

Q5 · MATHEMATICS · TIME

A train departs at 08:55 and the journey takes 2 hours 40 minutes. What time does it arrive?

A 11:35

C 11:25

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Q6 · MATHEMATICS · RATIO & PROPORTION

A recipe for 8 pancakes uses 200 ml of milk and 2 eggs. How much milk is needed to make 20 pancakes?

A 500 ml

B 250 ml

C 400 ml

D 600 ml

Q7 · NON-VERBAL REASONING · SEQUENCE

The shapes below follow a pattern. Which shape comes next?



OPTIONS:



A



B

C



D

(Option C represents a circle — no straight sides.)

A 7-sided (heptagon)

B Square

C Circle

D Pentagon

Q8 · NON-VERBAL REASONING · ODD ONE OUT

Four of these five shapes share a feature. Which is the odd one out?



A



B



C



D



E

A A

B B

C C

D D

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Q9 · NON-VERBAL REASONING · ANALOGY

The first pair shows a transformation. Apply the same transformation to the third shape. Which option (A–D) completes the pair?



A A

B B

C C

D D

Q10–Q12 · ENGLISH COMPREHENSION · READ THE PASSAGE, THEN ANSWER THE QUESTIONS BELOW

Antibiotics: Medicine's Greatest Weapon

In 1928, Alexander Fleming returned from holiday to find something unexpected in his laboratory at St Mary's Hospital, London. A mould had accidentally contaminated one of his petri dishes, and the bacteria surrounding it had been killed. Fleming had discovered penicillin — a substance that would transform medicine and save hundreds of millions of lives.

Antibiotics work by either killing bacteria directly or preventing them from reproducing. Different antibiotics target different parts of bacterial cells. Penicillin, for example, disrupts the construction of bacterial cell walls, causing the cells to burst. Other antibiotics interfere with the bacteria's ability to make proteins or copy their DNA.

The introduction of antibiotics in the 1940s was revolutionary. Infections that had previously been fatal — pneumonia, tuberculosis, and infected wounds — could suddenly be cured. Average life expectancy increased dramatically, and surgery became far safer because the risk of post-operative infection was dramatically reduced.

However, bacteria are evolving to resist antibiotics at an alarming rate. When antibiotics are overused or prescribed unnecessarily, resistant bacteria survive and multiply. The World Health Organisation has described antibiotic resistance as one of the greatest threats to global health.

Q10 · ENGLISH COMPREHENSION · FACT RETRIEVAL

In what year did Alexander Fleming discover penicillin?

A 1928

C 1918

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Q11 · ENGLISH COMPREHENSION · VOCABULARY IN CONTEXT

In the passage, the word 'revolutionary' (paragraph 3) is closest in meaning to:

A completely changing what was possible

B involving political protest

C happening very quickly

D extremely expensive

Q12 · ENGLISH COMPREHENSION · INFERENCE

Why did surgery become far safer once antibiotics were introduced?

A Wound infections that often killed patients could now be treated

B Surgeons performed operations more quickly

C Hospitals built better operating theatres

D Anaesthetics were also discovered at the same time

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Answer key & explanations

Read each explanation with your child — this is where the learning happens

Q1

A

VERBAL REASONING · ANTONYMS

Which word means the opposite of 'peace'?

'War' is the direct opposite of 'peace'. Violence, conflict and chaos are related to the absence of peace, but only 'war' names the precise antonym.

Q2

A

VERBAL REASONING · LETTER SEQUENCE

What comes next in the sequence? A E D H G ?

Two interleaved patterns: positions 1, 3, 5 give A → D → G (skip 2 letters each time). Positions 2, 4, 6 give E → H → ?. From H, skip 2 letters: I, J, K. Answer: K.

Q3

A

VERBAL REASONING · CODES

In a code, LAKE is coded as 3175 and KALE is coded as 7135. What is the code for LEAK?

From the two given codes, each letter has one digit: L=3, A=1, K=7, E=5. So LEAK = 3-5-1-7 = 3517.

Q4

A

MATHEMATICS · PERCENTAGES

A jacket costs £95. It is reduced by 40% in a sale. What is the sale price?

40% of £95 = £38 (the discount). Sale price = £95 - £38 = £57. Alternatively, 60% of £95 = £57.

Q5

A

MATHEMATICS · TIME

A train departs at 08:55 and the journey takes 2 hours 40 minutes. What time does it arrive?

08:55 + 2 hours = 10:55. 10:55 + 40 minutes = 11:35. Add the hours first, then add the minutes — easier than working in one step.

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Q6**A****MATHEMATICS · RATIO & PROPORTION**

A recipe for 8 pancakes uses 200 ml of milk and 2 eggs. How much milk is needed to make 20 pancakes?

Scale factor = $20 \div 8 = 2.5$. Milk = $200 \times 2.5 = 500$ ml. (The eggs are a distractor — the question only asks about milk.)

Q7**A****NON-VERBAL REASONING · SEQUENCE**

The shapes below follow a pattern. Which shape comes next?

The number of sides increases by 1 each step: 3, 4, 5, 6 → next has 7 sides (a heptagon). Look for the simplest rule: count the sides.

Q8**C****NON-VERBAL REASONING · ODD ONE OUT**

Four of these five shapes share a feature. Which is the odd one out?

Four of the shapes are filled (shaded grey). The odd one out is C — it is the only unshaded shape. The number of sides is a distractor; the shared feature is the fill.

Q9**A****NON-VERBAL REASONING · ANALOGY**

The first pair shows a transformation. Apply the same transformation to the third shape. Which option (A–D) completes the pair?

In the first pair, the shape stays the same but the dot inside becomes a horizontal line. Apply the same to the triangle: the triangle stays the same and the dot becomes a horizontal line. Answer: A.

Q10**A****ENGLISH COMPREHENSION · FACT RETRIEVAL**

In what year did Alexander Fleming discover penicillin?

The opening sentence states: 'In 1928, Alexander Fleming returned from holiday...' Always check the exact wording of the passage rather than relying on memory.

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Q11

A

ENGLISH COMPREHENSION · VOCABULARY IN CONTEXT

In the passage, the word 'revolutionary' (paragraph 3) is closest in meaning to:

Look at how the word is used: the next sentences explain that previously fatal infections could be cured and surgery became far safer. The author means that antibiotics changed what medicine could do — option A.

Q12

A

ENGLISH COMPREHENSION · INFERENCE

Why did surgery become far safer once antibiotics were introduced?

The passage links safer surgery directly to 'the risk of post-operative infection was dramatically reduced'. Inference questions reward staying close to the text — pick the option the passage actually supports.

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Where to go from here

Suggestions based on how this paper felt

Most questions felt manageable (9–12 right)

A good starting point. The next step is tackling more challenging question types and practising under stricter timed conditions — that's where preparation tends to make the biggest difference.

A mixed result (5–8 right)

This is the most common starting point, so there is no cause for concern. Notice which subject area felt hardest and spend a few practice sessions there — focused practice in one area usually has the most visible effect.

Found it quite difficult (0–4 right)

These questions reflect the difficulty level typical of this type of preparation material, which is deliberately harder than most school work. Start with vocabulary for Verbal Reasoning, times-tables fluency for Maths, and one shape rule at a time for Non-Verbal Reasoning. Little and often works well at this stage.

Get an indicative picture of readiness

The free Readiness Check is timed, instantly marked, and produces an indicative readiness score against our 121 readiness benchmark — along with the three areas most worth focusing on next.



12 questions · timed · no account needed · instant results

Independent practice indicator — not an official test score.

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